

The Problem

University friend groups have trouble organising meetups, typically due to poor communication.

From our interviews and our survey of 46 people, we found out that it is often the case people usually wait to see who else responds before they decide, leading to friction in the group chat.

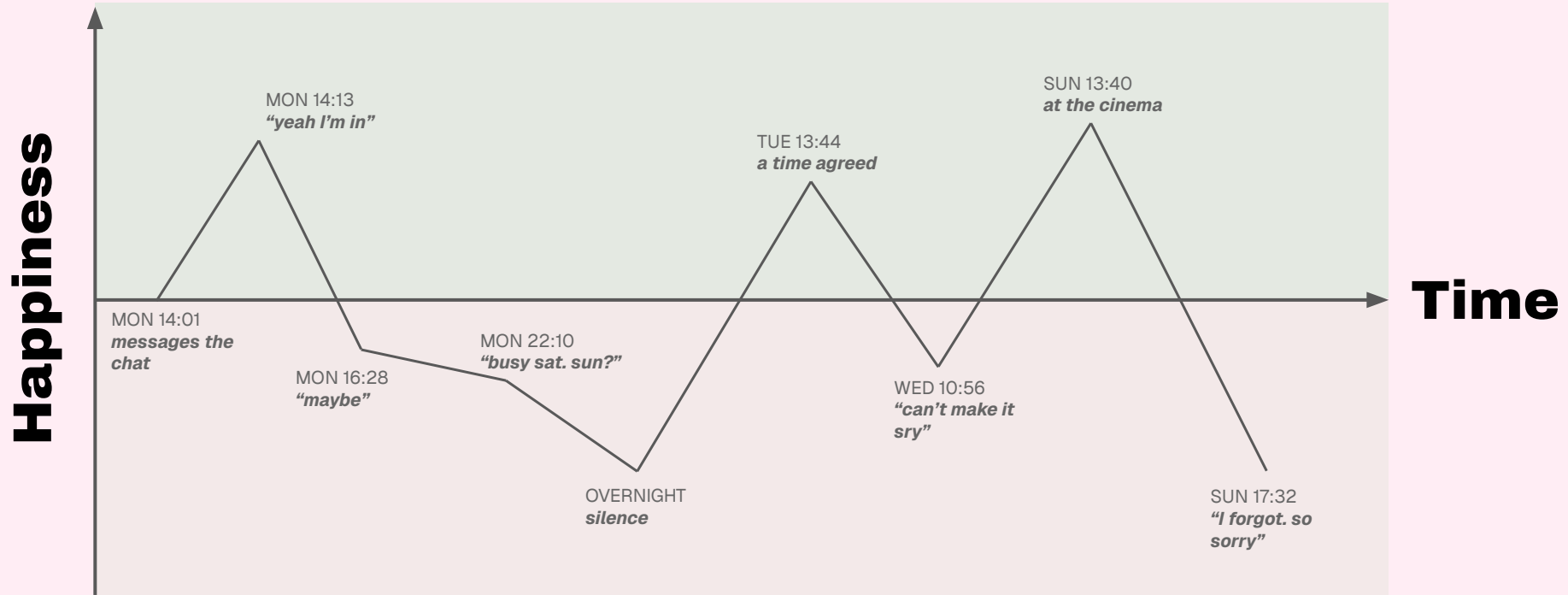


Vasanth

- Age 21
- Studies Law at St. Andrews
- Enjoys playing volleyball and board games
- Loves to cook for his friends
- Extroverted and reliable

The organiser.

One plan. From the *suggestion*, to the empty seat.



For people like Vasanth, who often organise their friends, choosing the wrong time for a meetup can be a common cause for people saying 'maybe' and then never turning up.

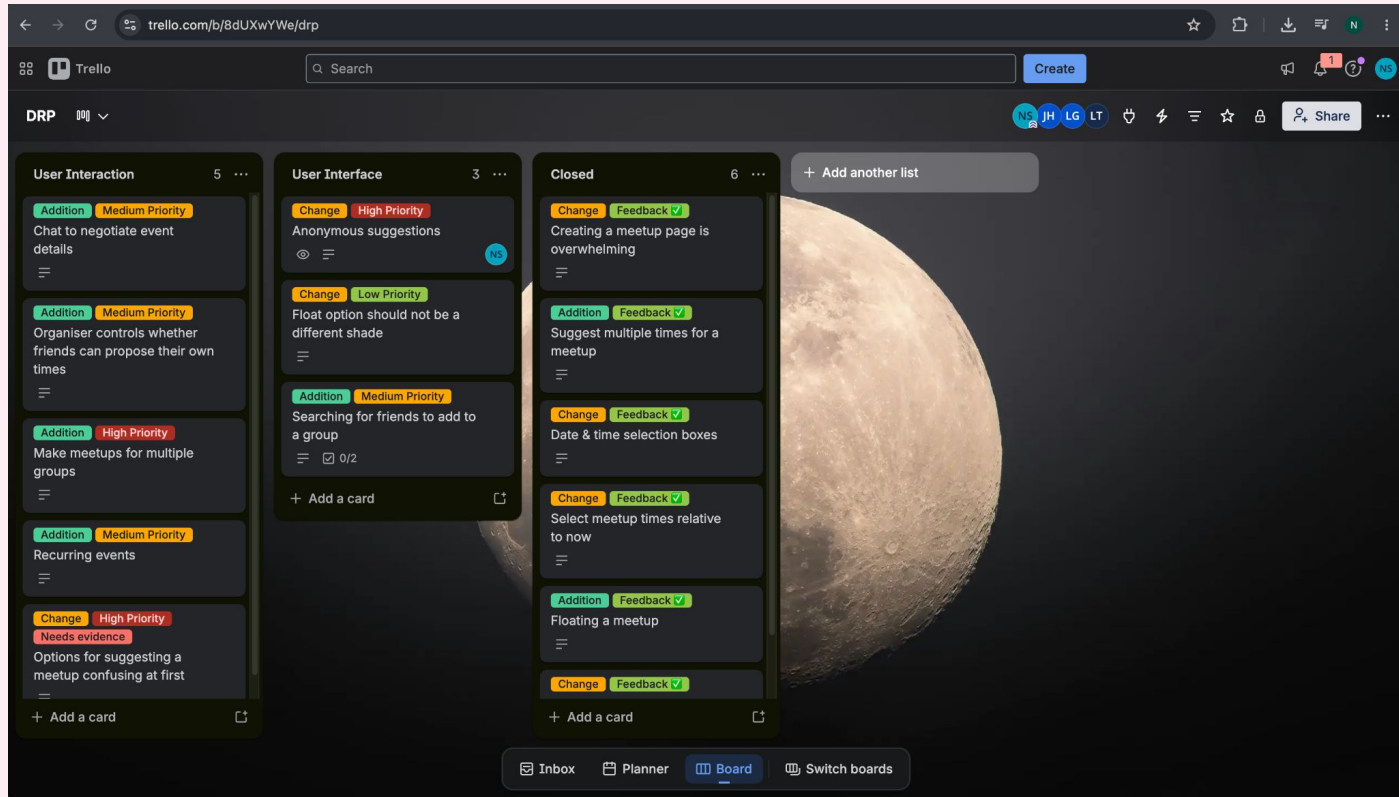
79% of university friend groups we asked said the meetup time got moved more often than not.

"How might we reduce hesitancy in university friend groups when planning to meet up so that groups go from frustrating 'maybe' responses to a clear consensus?"

Our Focus This Week

**Getting the ball rolling:
Meetup suggestion and confirmation**

Iteration planning



Iteration 1

Where we left off last week

Suggest a meet

GROUP

Lithuanian Study Group

Climbing Group

TITLE

Bouldering

LOCATION

Vauxwall East

DATE

2026-06-10

TIME

14:00

Create

Meetups

Groups

Account

Climbing Group

14th June 2026

Bouldering Session

VauxWall East · 12:00

Are you in?

✓ I'm in

I'll go if...

Can't make it

Meetups

Groups

Account

17:39BeReal

The Boys

Thu 4 Jun, 18:00

Dune: Part Two

Cineworld Bexleyheath

Looks 16:51

Are you in?

No one sees who's in until the timer ends. Answer honestly.

✓ I'm in

I'll go if...

Can't make it

I'll go if...

...these people are going

At least one

All of them

A

Adi

✓

L

Lily

J

Joe

N

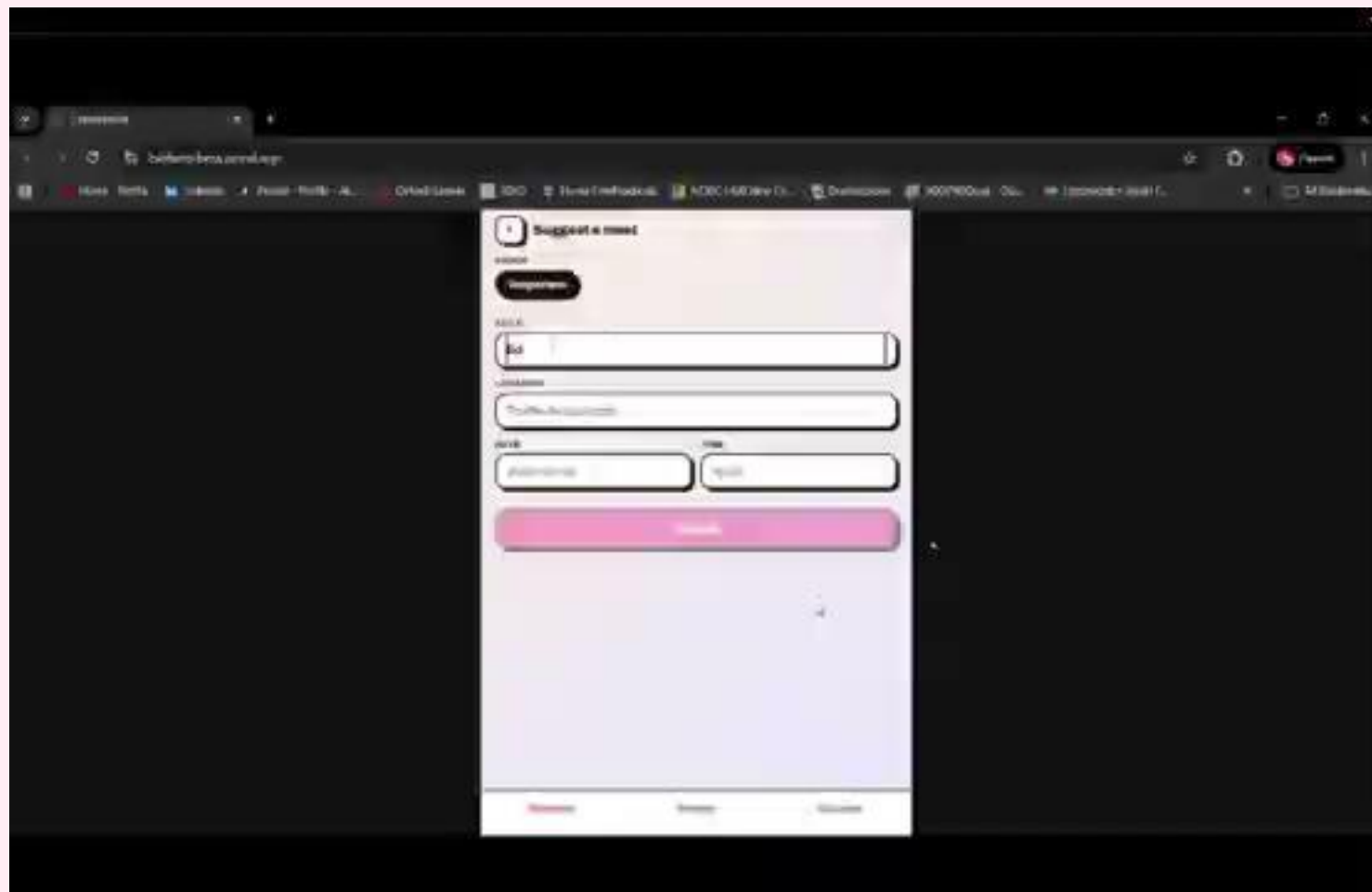
Nathan

✓

B

Bethan

Confirm



Iteration 1 - Findings

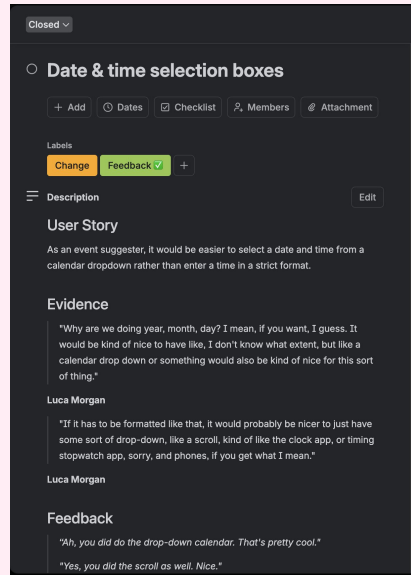
What we learnt:

- The current system of manually typing in the meetup date and time is inconvenient

Iteration 2

Iteration 2 - Implementation Plan

- Replace the text field for date with a calendar interface.
- Replace the text field for time with a time picker interface.



14:39

68

<

Suggest a meet

GROUP

The Boys

Climbing Group

Glitter Natters

Church Group

High School Reunion

TITLE

Bowling

LOCATION

TenPin Bexleyheath

WHEN

Set a time

It's happening - who's in?

DATE

Tue, Oct 6

TIME

3:45 PM

PICK A TIME

1100

1215

1330

1445

1500

1615

1730

Done

14:39

68

<

Suggest a meet

GROUP

The Boys

Climbing Group

Glitter Natters

Church Group

High School Reunion

TITLE

Bowling

LOCATION

TenPin Bexleyheath

WHEN

Set a time

PICK A DATE

October 2026

<

>

MON

TUE

WED

THU

FRI

SAT

SUN

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

13

14

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31

Done

“Would you say the meetup suggestion page supports everything you need when trying to organise a meet with your friends?”



Iteration 2 - Findings

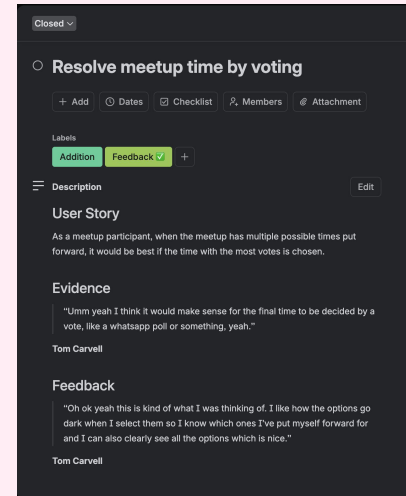
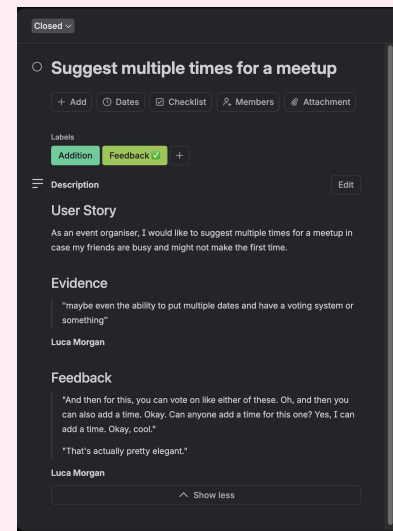
What we learnt:

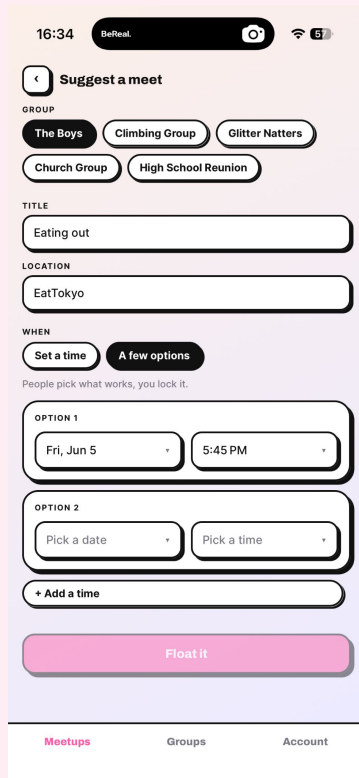
- Users sometimes want to suggest multiple times for a meetup
- Voting on a preferred time is an acceptable mechanism for deciding on a meetup time for some users

Iteration 3

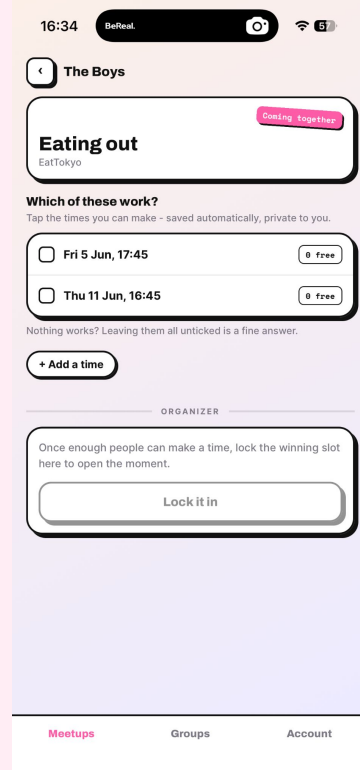
Iteration 3 - Implementation Plan

- Add multiple date/time pickers in the meetup suggestion interface.
- If there are multiple dates/times, allow group members to vote on a time first, as well as suggest what times work for them, before saying if they are in or not.

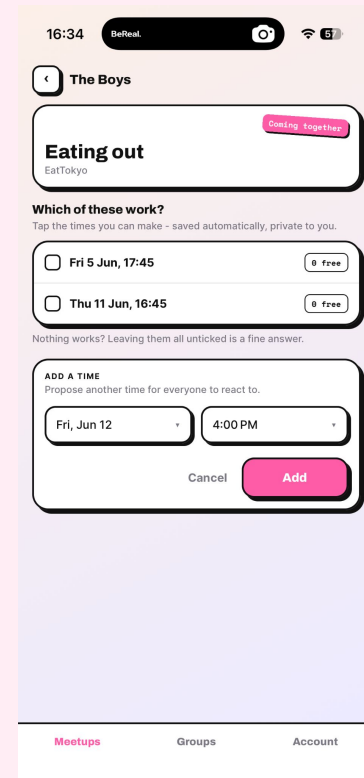
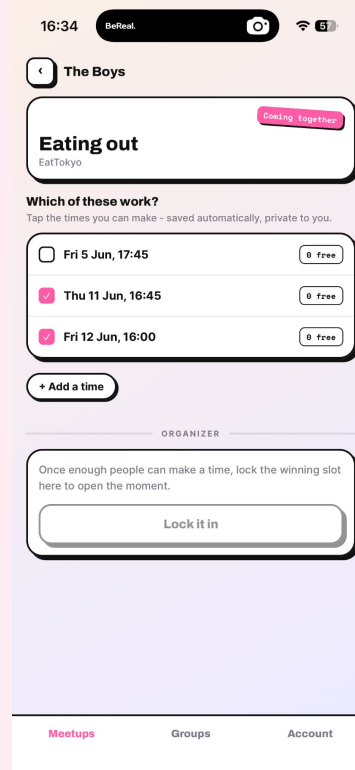




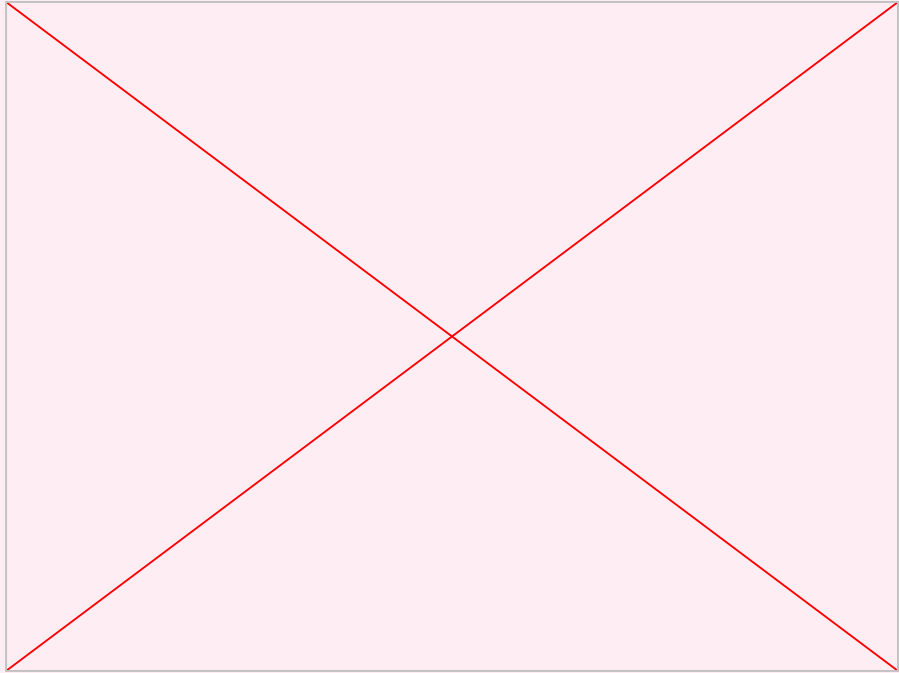
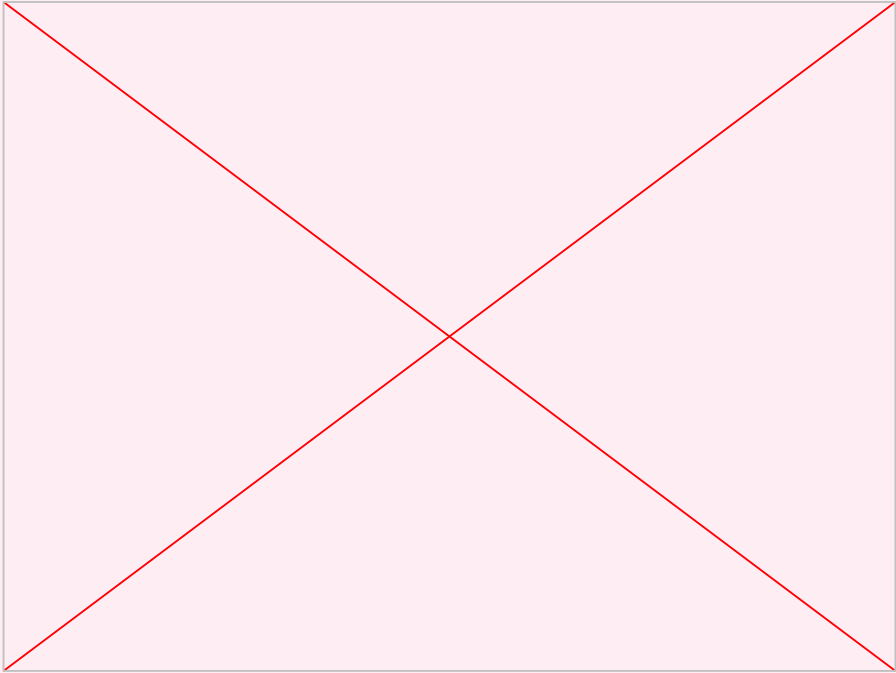
Suggestor can suggest multiple dates and times.



Participants can vote on a time that suits them.



Optionally they can also suggest their own times that work for them.



Iteration 3 - Findings

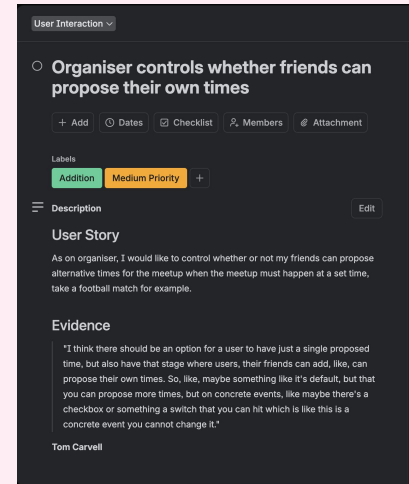
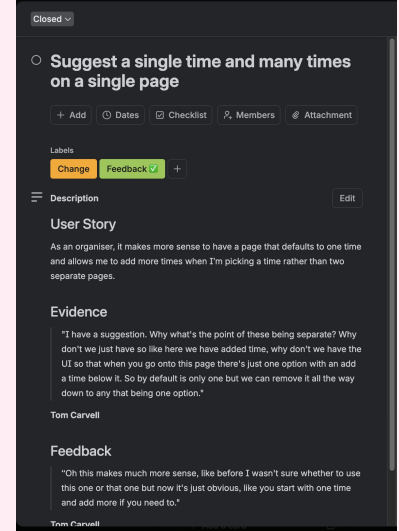
What we learnt:

- Suggesting a single time and suggesting multiple times do not deserve separate screens, suggesting one or more in the same place would be more appropriate.
- The deadline to vote on times should have a sensible default (for example one day before the event) which the organiser can customise.
- Organisers should choose whether friends can suggest amendments to the proposed time.

Iteration 4

Iteration 4 - Implementation Plan

- Split meetup suggestion into two types of meetups.
- **Flexible** allows other people to suggest times, includes a time voting phase before people say they're in. The organiser should also be able to suggest one or more times.
- A flexible meetup should have a sensible default lock in time.
- **Fixed** is a single set-time that others cannot change.



20:05

<

Suggest a meet

LOCATION

optional

TenPin Bexleyheath

NOTES

optional

Come at 6, we'll eat around 8

WHEN

Flexible

Fixed

Offer a time or two; people react and it locks at a deadline.

Tomorrow eve

This Sat

Sat eve

Next week

Thu, Jun 4

▼

10:15 PM

▼

+ Add a time

LOCKS IN

Locks Wed 3 Jun, 22:15

the evening before - best-supported time wins

Change

Float it

Add a title to continue

Meetups

Groups

Account

20:08

<

The Boys

LOCKS IN

11h 25m

best-supported time wins

Dancing

Which of these work?

Tap the times you can make - private to you.

☐ Wed 3 Jun, 19:00

☐ Sat 6 Jun, 13:00

+ Add a time

☐ I can't make it
you won't be asked again - tap a time to rejoin

Force lock now (dev)

Meetups

Groups

Account



Suggest a meet

Only the group, a title and a time are needed - everything tagged "optional" can wait.

GROUP

Combined - The boys and Climbing

The Boys

Climbing Group

Glitter Natters

Church Group

High School Reunion

TITLE

Bowling

LOCATION optional

TenPin Bexleyheath

NOTES optional

Come at 6, we'll eat around 8

WHEN

Flexible

Fixed

Offer a time or two; people react and it locks at a deadline.

Tonight

Tomorrow eve

This Sat

Sat eve

Next week

Wed 1 Jul



13:00



Iteration 4 - Findings

What we learnt:

- Too much information on the suggest meetup page.
- Users feel overwhelmed with too many options

Iteration 5

Iteration 5 - Implementation Plan

- Break up the suggest a meetup form into a multi-page wizard instead of a single large, confusing form

Closed ▾

○

Creating a meetup page is overwhelming

+ Add

🕒 Dates

☑ Checklist

👤 Members

📎 Attachment

Labels

Change

Feedback ✓

+

≡

Description

Edit

User Story

As an organiser, when I create a new meetup there is lots of information on that page and it can feel slightly overwhelming.

Evidence

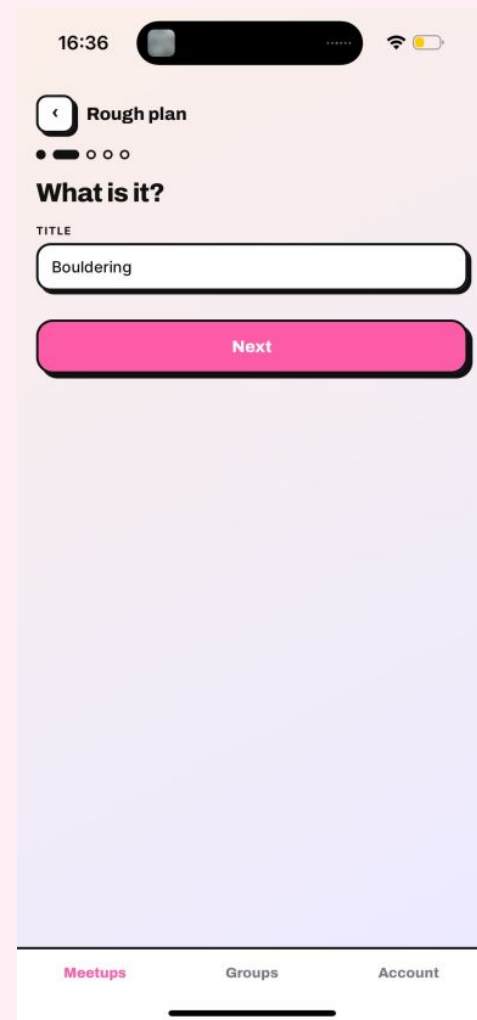
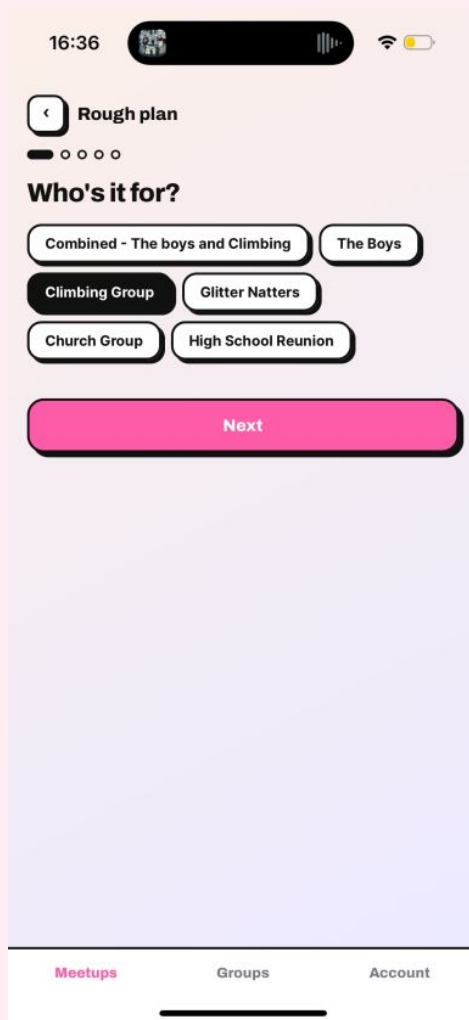
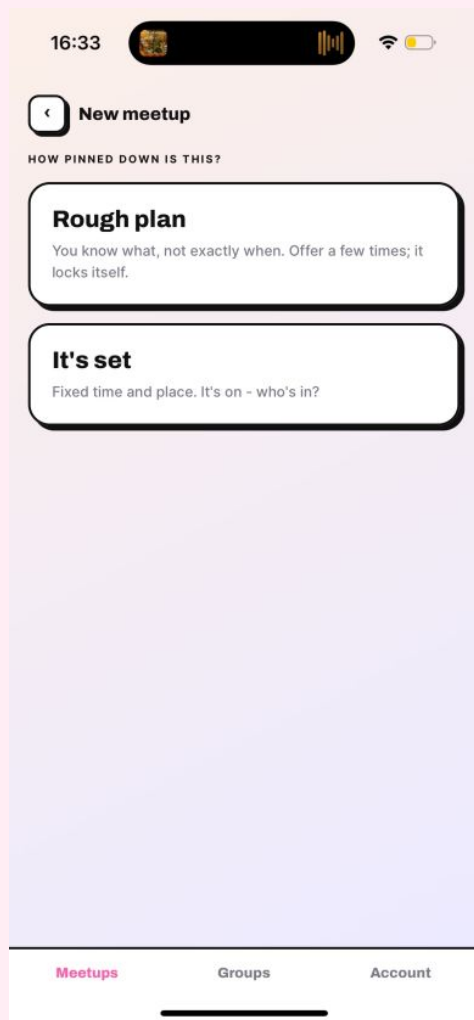
"it takes me a second to read through to make sure that everything I understand, like where to put every single thing and what each thing does. This is like, especially with the boxes. So maybe adding more space between the boxes might help or I don't know, laying it out a bit differently."

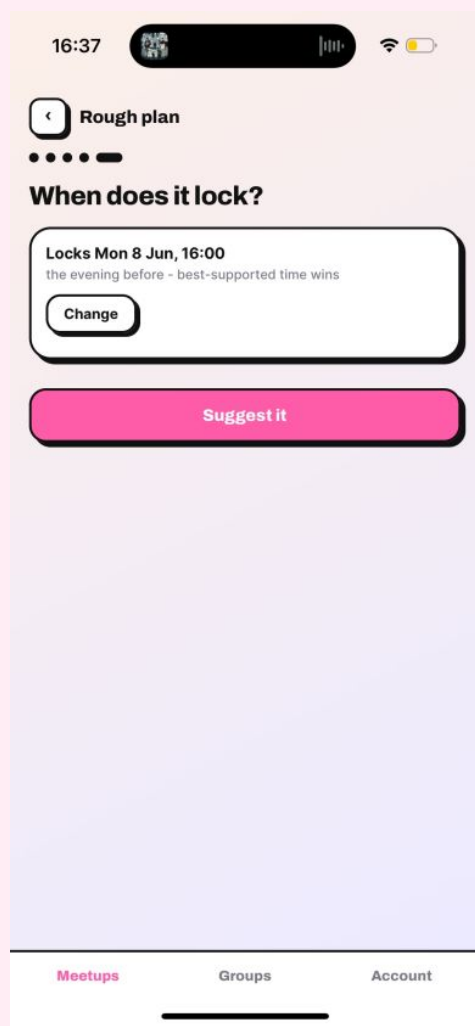
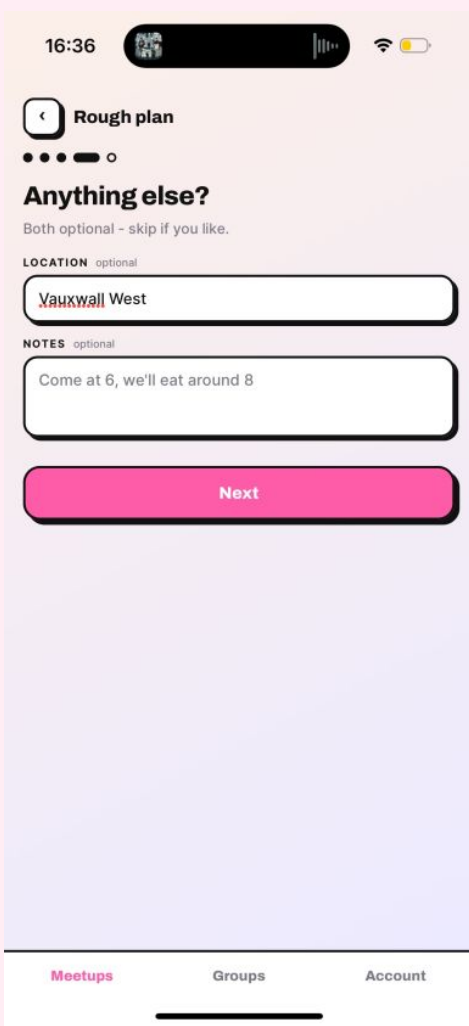
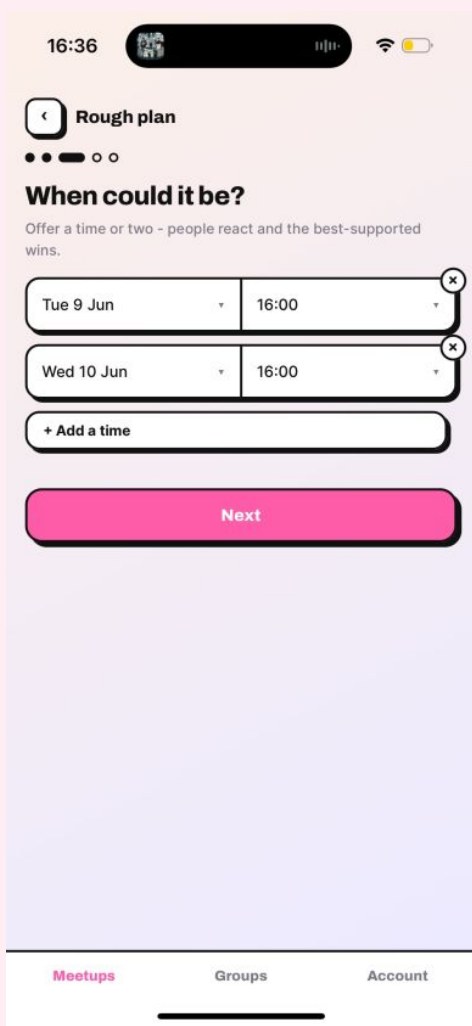
Zack Foreman

Feedback

"As a general wizard, it's pretty cool. It's very simple... it's easy to fill out. It's very clear as well. I think as soon as I read these, I also kind of almost immediately figured out what each one is like."

Zack Foreman





“Do you see yourself using the app every time you want to suggest a meetup with your friends?”



Iteration 5 - Findings

- New step-by-step approach to creating suggestions is much nicer to use.
- People would use the app simply just for gathering everyone's availability, even if the activity isn't decided.

Iteration 6

Iteration 6 - Implementation Plan

- Add a third type of meetup suggestion that supports floating the idea of meeting up.
- This type of meetup should allow everyone to suggest ideas and times that work, which everybody votes on.
- At a deadline, the activity and time locks and members say whether they are in or out.

Closed ▾

Floating a meetup

+ Add

🕒 Dates

☑ Checklist

👤 Members

📎 Attachment

Labels

Addition

Feedback ✓

+

Description

Edit

User Story

As an meetup suggester I would like to be able to suggest a meetup more loosely - just float the idea and have the group decide when and where to meet more collaboratively.

Evidence

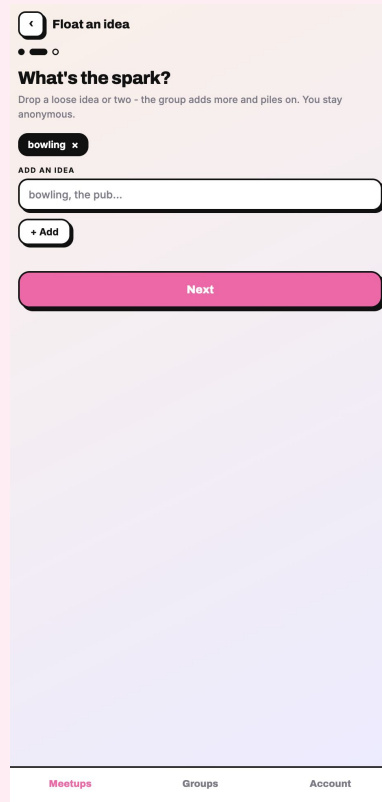
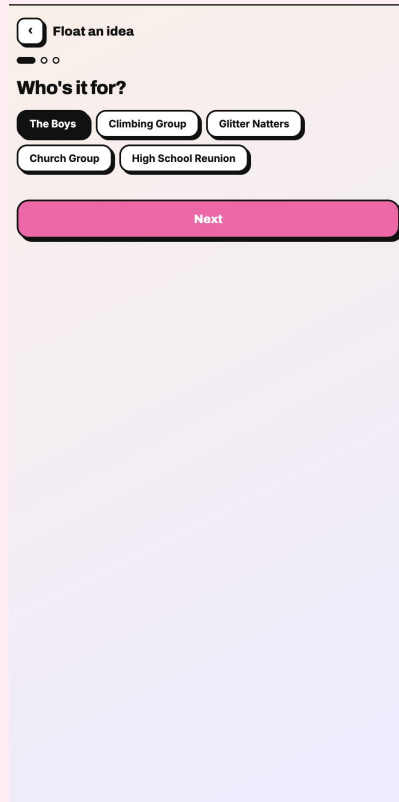
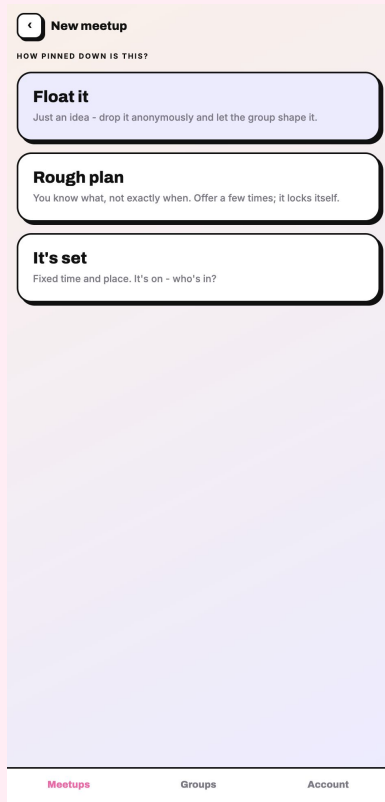
"I think that's part of the issue with this is when you do the suggested meetup, like I have to put in a hard time."

Felicity Turner

Feedback

"That actually does seem pretty cool. It's a quick way to decide to meet up."

Luca Morgan





Climbing Group

Brewing

auto-tips 21h 23m

Someone floated an idea

No names shown. Tap what you're into - a +1 means you're keen, not committed. When it catches on it turns into a real plan and asks who's in.

What could we do?

bowling 2

the pub 1

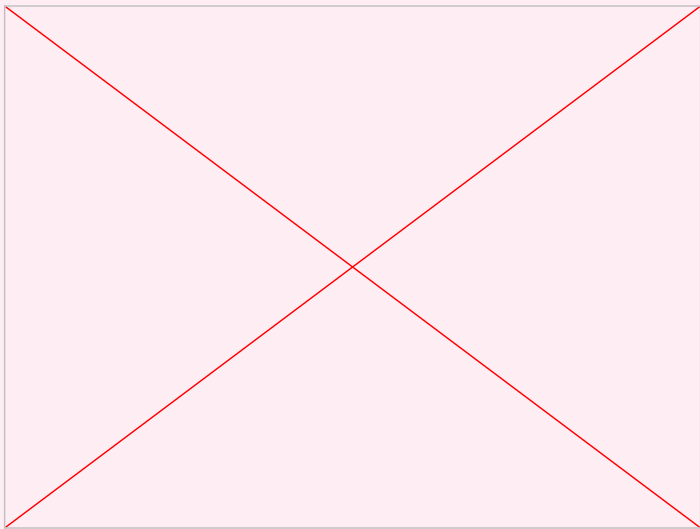
+ add an idea

When works?

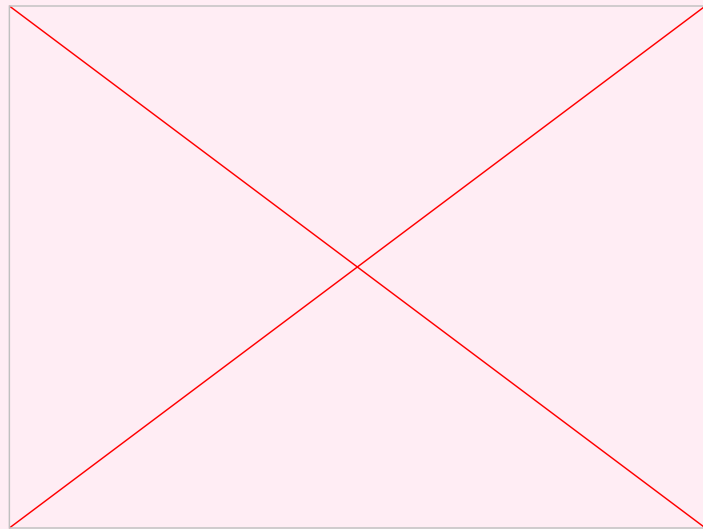
Fri 5 Jun · Evening 2

Sat 6 Jun · Afternoon 1

+ add a time



“How intuitive is the meetup suggestion workflow?”



“Talk us through your thoughts when using the suggest a meetup feature.”

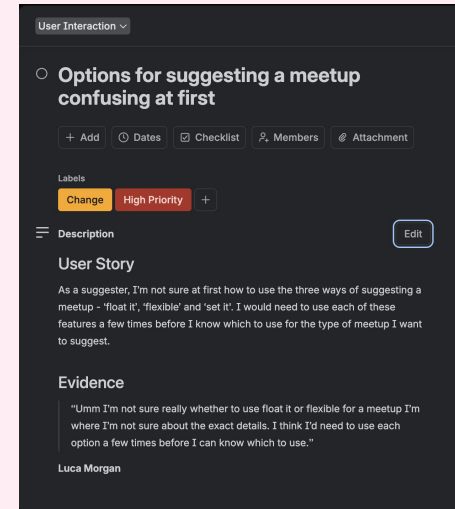
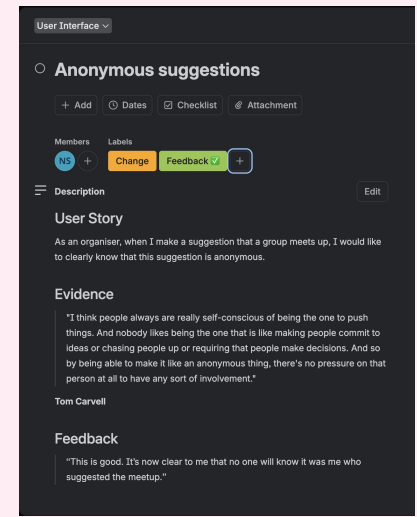
Iteration 6 - Findings

- It's not clear that the suggester of a meetup is anonymous.
- It's not clear how the three options of suggesting meetups actually work.
For a same-day meetup, it would require a bit of experience with using all the options to get a feel for which option is best.

Iteration 7

Iteration 7 - Implementation Plan

- Remove the three options for the type of meetup at the start of the wizard. Instead, allow the suggester to optionally skip filling out details of the meetup, and the app decides the next steps for the group based on what information was filled.
- Add a tip to make it clear suggesting a meetup is anonymous at the end of the meetup wizard.





New meetup



Who's it for?

The Boys

Next

Meetups

Groups

Account



New meetup



What do you fancy?

Drop a few activities - optional, and the group can add more. No names - it's the group's.

pub



ADD AN ACTIVITY optional

bowling, the pub...

Add

Next

Meetups

Groups

Account



New meetup



When could it be?

Offer a time or two, or skip - people react and the best-supported wins. Optional.

11/06/2026



18:00



+ Add a time

Next

Meetups

Groups

Account

New meetup

A few options

All optional - skip if you like.

LOCATION

optional

TenPin Bexleyheath

NOTES

optional

Come at 6, we'll eat around 8

☐

Lock the times
The group can't add more times

☐

Lock the activity
The group can't add more activities

Decides by

Decides Wed 10 Jun, 18:00
before your earliest time - best-supported wins

Change

Reply by

Replies close Thu 11 Jun, 10:00
blind until then - then it reveals who's in

Change

Next

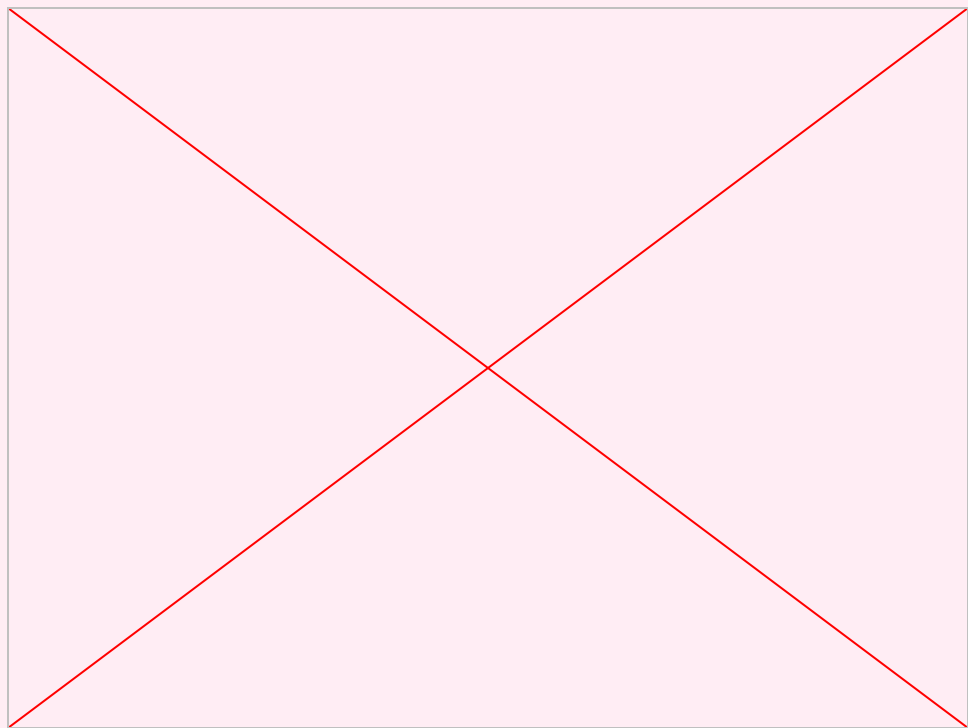
New meetup

Ready to send?

The group suggests times (activity set), then who's in.

SENT ANONYMOUSLY
The group sees the meetup, never that it came from you. No names, ever.

Send to the group



Iteration 7 - Findings

- Often, people have very similar meetups.
- Going through the wizard fresh just for a meetup you want repeated (e.g. dungeons and dragons) is annoying

Final Iteration

Final Implementation Plan

- Create the option to reuse a previous meetup when suggesting one.
- Reusing a meetup simply pre-fills all the meetup details (activity, location, etc.)

Closed ▾

○ Recurring events

+ Add

🕒 Dates

☑ Checklist

👤 Members

📎 Attachment

Labels

Addition

Feedback ✓

+

≡ Description

Edit

User Story

As a suggester and an attendant, I would like to be able to have an event that is recurring, a pub quiz for example, so I don't need to make the same event each week myself. Or if not a recurring event, I'd like to be able to create a new event from an existing template say to speed up the process of making the new meetup when I do so often.

Evidence

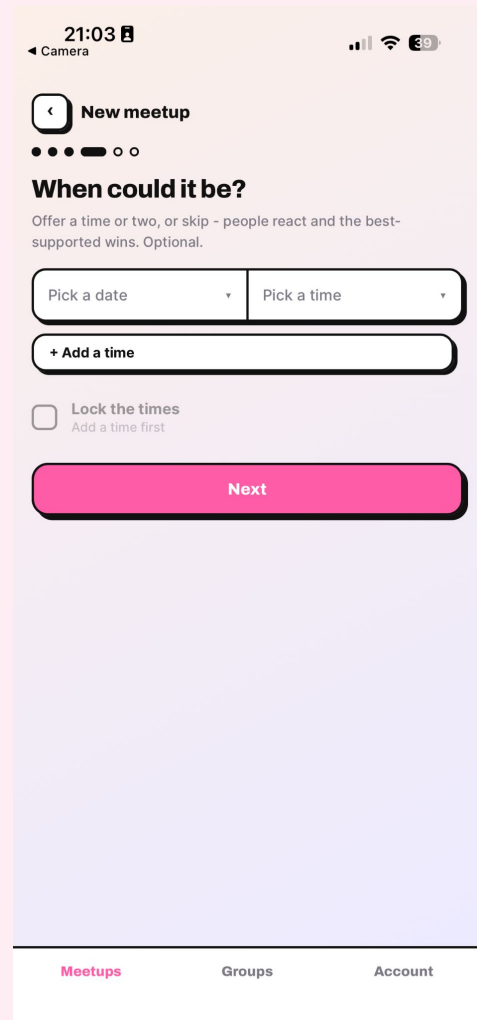
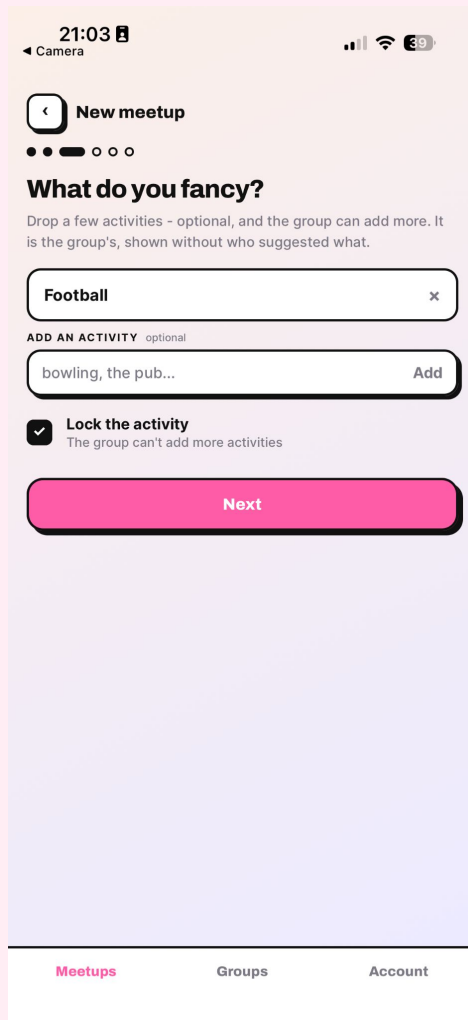
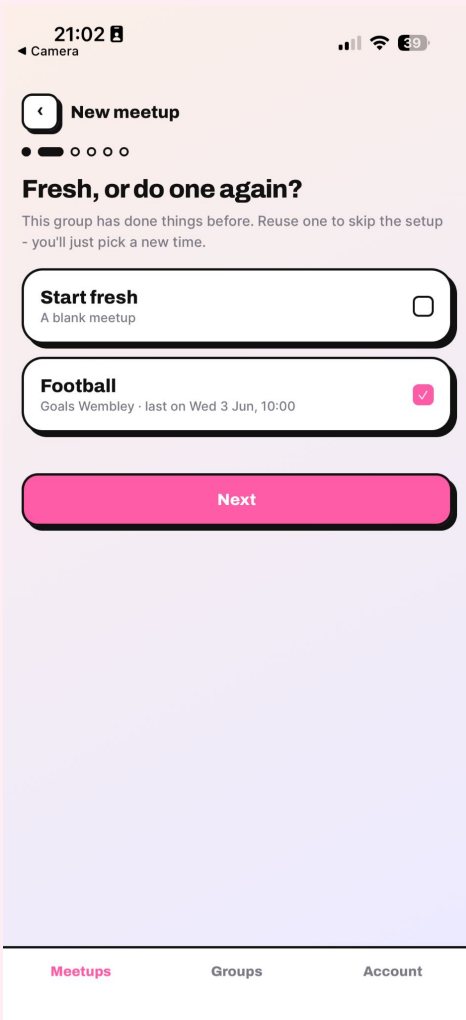
"I think certain events... things particularly like D&D tend to be recurring. They tend to be around the same time each week or each couple of weeks, right? And it's not unique to that specifically... It's a very common thing, I think, where people play board games on a certain night, or they tend to go to the pub at a certain time."

Luca Morgan

Feedback

"Oh yeah, this is much more convenient. Now I don't have to type stuff for no reason and repeat myself."

⏶ Show less



21:03

Camera

39

<

New meetup

●●●●●○

A few options

All optional - skip if you like.

LOCATION optional

Goals Wembley

NOTES optional

Come at 6, we'll eat around 8

Decides by

A sensible deadline
add times to set this, or we'll pick a horizon

Next

Meetups

Groups

Account

21:03

Camera

39

<

New meetup

●●●●●●

Ready to send?

No fixed time yet - the group suggests the times (activity already set), best-supported wins, then who's in.

Shown without names - it is the group's.

Send to the group

Meetups

Groups

Account

